Seiwoong Hong

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Education

The Ohio State University, Fisher College of Business
Ph.D. in Finance, 2021 - Present (Expected May 2027)

Korea Advanced Institute of Science and Technology (KAIST)
M.S. in Management Engineering (Finance), 2019 - 2021
B.S. in Mathematical Science, 2012 - 2019 (including two years of mandated military service)

Research Areas

Corporate Finance, Innovation, and Entrepreneurial Finance

Working Papers

Build On or Branch Out? Patent Grants and Peers' Innovation Policies *(Job market paper)*

Abstract: When a firm is granted a patent, its technologically related peers can gain from the disclosed knowledge or lose from the patentee's stronger exclusion rights. Instrumenting grants with patent examiner leniency, I find that granting a patent on an important innovation raises R&D expenses among technologically close peers and shifts the patenting of close product-market rivals toward new technologies. Stock market reactions on the grant date reveal which force dominates for a given peer. When the stock prices of both the patentee and the peer rise, the peer raises R&D expenses by about 7% and its acquisition probability by 3 percentage points and builds on the granted patent's technology; when the peer's stock price falls, it moves its patenting away from that technology. Financial flexibility amplifies these responses, and patent enforcement limits expansion.

- *Award:* Korea-America Finance Association Best Doctoral Dissertation Award (2026)
- *Presentations:* FMA Special PhD Paper Presentations (2026); FMA Doctoral Student Consortium (2026); 22nd Annual Olin Finance Conference at WashU (PhD Session) (2026); The Ohio State University Finance Brownbag Seminar (2026)

Funding the Uncommon: Financial Incentives and Corporate Investment in Rare Disease Innovation

Abstract: Can financial incentives redirect corporate innovation toward socially valuable projects with limited commercial markets? I study the Rare Pediatric Disease Priority Review Voucher program, which provides a transferable financial reward for successful drug development. Using clinical-trial data and a difference-in-differences design, I find that the program increases public-firm participation in eligible drug development, including entry and continued investment in existing projects. The response primarily reflects an expansion of firms' innovation portfolios rather than substitution away from other projects. These findings show that outcome-contingent financial incentives can affect both the level and direction of corporate innovation.

Work in Progress

Intangible Capital and the Boundaries of the Firm *(with René Stulz)*

Trading the Grid: Financial Traders in Electricity Markets *(with Dustin Bae, Itzhak Ben-David, and Hyeongjun Kim)*

Research Experience

Fisher College of Business (Ohio State University), Columbus, USA Aug 2021 - Present
Graduate Research Associate

- For Professor Kewei Hou — Aug 2021 - May 2022
- For Professor Petra Vokata — May 2022 - Aug 2022
- For Professor Ingrid Werner — Aug 2022 - Jan 2023
- For Professor Tom Meling — Jan 2023 - May 2024, Jan 2025 - May 2025
- For Professor Sergey Sarkisyan — Aug 2024 - Dec 2024
- For Professor Mike Wittry — Aug 2025 - Jan 2026

Teaching

- Corporate Finance (Undergraduate) — May 2024 – Aug 2024
  Overall Instructor Rating: 4.65/5.00 (University Average: 4.49/5.00)

Professional Experience

- Referee: Financial Management, Journal of Empirical Finance

Skills

- Software and Programming: Stata, Python, R, MATLAB, and LaTeX.
- Languages: English (fluent) and Korean (native)

References

René Stulz (Chair)
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The Ohio State University
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Tom Meling
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Mike Wittry
Assistant Professor of Finance
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